

Word family: **situation / situations / situational / situationally**

Base word: situation

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Related forms:

* **situation** (n.) — 情況；處境；局面；位置

* **situational** (adj.) — 與特定情況有關的；情境性的

* **situationally** (adv.) — 按情況地；視情境而定

* **situated** (adj./participle) — 位於；處於某種位置或處境

* **situate** (v.) — 使位於；把.....置於某位置 / 背景中

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **in this situation**

* **difficult situation**

* **awkward situation**

* **serious situation**

* **current situation**

* **financial situation**

* **family situation**

* **work situation**

* **handle a situation**

* **deal with a situation**

* **improve the situation**

* **mend the situation**

* **make the situation worse**

* **understand the situation**

* **situation changes**

* **situational awareness**

* **situational factors**

* **be situated in / near**

* **situate something in context**

Meaning in this passage

> ...when it is honest, timely, and specific, it can really mend the **situation**.

Here, **situation** means:

the difficult interpersonal circumstances created by the misunderstanding and public accusation — 局面；情況

The apology could not erase what happened, but it could improve the damaged relationship and reduce the tension.

****中文翻譯：****

只要道歉是真誠、及時而且具體的，就真的可以****修補局面****。

So here:

****situation = 某一刻由事件、人物和條件共同形成的整體情況或局面****

1. ****situation (情況；局面) — 情況；局面****

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> A sincere apology can help ****mend the situation****.

真誠的道歉可以幫助****修補局面****。

Practice 2

> The ****situation**** became more tense after the argument.

爭吵後，****局面****變得更緊張。

Practice 3

> We need to understand the ****situation**** before making a decision.

作決定前，我們需要先了解****情況****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****situation = 某一時間點由不同事件、人物和條件共同形成的整體情況****

2. ****in this situation — 在這種情況下****

Practice 1

> What would you do ****in this situation****?

在這種**情況下**，你會怎樣做？

Practice 2

> It is important to stay calm **in this situation**.

在這種**情況下**保持冷靜很重要。

MCQ-ready definition:

in this situation = 在目前這種特定情況或條件下

3. **difficult situation — 困難處境**

Practice 1

> She handled the **difficult situation** very well.

她把那個**困難局面**處理得很好。

Practice 2

> We were all in a **difficult situation**.

我們當時都處於一個**困難處境**。

MCQ-ready definition:

difficult situation = 難以處理、容易出問題或令人有壓力的情況

4. **awkward situation — 尷尬局面**

Practice 1

> His comment created an **awkward situation**.

他的評論造成了一個**尷尬局面**。

Practice 2

> I didn't know what to say in the **awkward situation**.

在那個**尷尬情況**下，我不知道該說甚麼。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****awkward situation = 令人不自在、不知如何反應或社交上尷尬的局面****

5. ****serious situation — 嚴重情況****

Practice 1

> This is a ****serious situation****.

這是一個****嚴重情況****。

Practice 2

> The manager realized how ****serious the situation**** was.

經理意識到****情況有多嚴重****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****serious situation = 可能帶來重大後果、需要認真處理的情況****

6. ****current situation — 目前情況****

Practice 1

> We need to review the ****current situation****.

我們需要檢視****目前情況****。

Practice 2

> The ****current situation**** is much better than before.

****目前的情況****比以前好很多。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****current situation = 現在正在存在或發生的情況****

7. ****financial situation — 財務狀況****

A common domain-specific use.

Practice 1

> Their **financial situation** improved.

他們的**財務狀況**有所改善。

Practice 2

> He explained his **financial situation** to the bank.

他向銀行解釋自己的**財務狀況**。

MCQ-ready definition:

financial situation = 某人或機構目前在收入、開支、債務和資產方面的整體狀況

8. **family situation** — 家庭狀況

Practice 1

> The teacher understood her **family situation**.

老師理解她的**家庭狀況**。

Practice 2

> His **family situation** made travel difficult.

他的**家庭情況**令旅行變得困難。

MCQ-ready definition:

family situation = 某人家庭中影響生活的整體條件和 circumstances

9. **work situation** — 工作處境；工作情況

Practice 1

> My **work situation** has changed recently.

我的**工作情況**最近有變。

Practice 2

> She wanted to improve her **work situation**.

她想改善自己的**工作處境**。

MCQ-ready definition:

work situation = 某人在工作方面所處的條件、安排和環境

10. **handle a situation — 處理局面**

Practice 1

> She **handled the situation** calmly.

她冷靜地**處理了局面**。

Practice 2

> He didn't know how to **handle the situation**.

他不知道該怎樣**處理這個情況**。

MCQ-ready definition:

handle a situation = 以某種方式管理和應對正在發生的情況

11. **deal with a situation — 應付 / 處理情況**

Practice 1

> We need to **deal with the situation** quickly.

我們需要迅速**處理這個情況**。

Practice 2

> She is good at **dealing with difficult situations**.

她很擅長**應付困難局面**。

MCQ-ready definition:

deal with a situation = 採取行動應對並處理某個情況

12. **improve the situation — 改善情況**

Practice 1

> Better communication could **improve the situation**.

更好的溝通可以**改善情況**。

Practice 2

> Nothing seemed to **improve the situation**.

似乎沒有甚麼能**改善局面**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****improve the situation = 令目前的情況變得更好****

13. **make the situation worse — 令情況惡化**

Practice 1

> Arguing would only **make the situation worse**.

爭吵只會**令情況更糟**。

Practice 2

> His public criticism **made the situation worse**.

他的公開批評**令局面惡化**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****make the situation worse = 令原有問題或困難變得更嚴重****

14. **understand the situation — 了解情況**

Practice 1

> He finally **understood the situation**.

他終於**了解了實際情況**。

Practice 2

> You need all the facts to **understand the situation** properly.

你需要掌握全部事實，才能真正**了解情況**。

MCQ-ready definition:

understand the situation = 掌握事件、背景和相關條件，知道實際發生甚麼

15. **situation changes — 情況改變**

Practice 1

> The **situation changed** after his apology.

他道歉後，**情況改變了**。

Practice 2

> We will adjust the plan if the **situation changes**.

如果**情況有變**，我們會調整計劃。

MCQ-ready definition:

the situation changes = 整體條件、事件或關係出現變化

16. **situation (處境；個人所處狀態) — 處境**

A slightly more personal sense.

Practice 1

> I wouldn't want to be in his **situation**.

我不想處於他的**處境**。

Practice 2

> Try to see the problem from her **situation**.

試着從她的**處境**理解問題。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****situation = 某人當時所處的生活、工作或人際條件****

17. ****be in a difficult situation — 身處困境****

Practice 1

> She found herself ****in a difficult situation****.

她發現自己****身處困境****。

Practice 2

> He was in a ****very awkward situation****.

他當時處於一個非常****尷尬的處境****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be in a situation = 處於某種特定條件或局面之中****

18. ****situation (位置；所在地) — 位置；地勢****

A more formal and less common sense, especially in property descriptions.

Practice 1

> The hotel has a beautiful ****situation**** overlooking the sea.

酒店的位置很好，可以俯瞰大海。

Practice 2

> The house enjoys a quiet ****situation**** near the river.

這間屋位於河邊一個安靜的****位置****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****situation = formal: the physical location or setting of a building or place****

This sense is much less common in everyday modern English than ****location****.

19. ****situated (位於) — 位於 ; 坐落於****

A major related form.

Practice 1

> The library is ****situated near the station****.

圖書館****位於車站附近****。

Practice 2

> The hotel is ****situated in the city centre****.

酒店****坐落於市中心****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be situated in/near X = 位於 X 地方或附近****

20. ****well-situated — 位置良好的****

Practice 1

> The apartment is ****well-situated**** for public transport.

這個單位的位置對乘搭公共交通來說****很方便****。

Practice 2

> The hotel is ****well-situated**** near several attractions.

酒店****位置很好****，附近有多個景點。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****well-situated = 位於方便、有利或理想的位置****

21. ****situate something — 把.....放在某位置****

Practice 1

> The building was **situated** away from the main road.

建築被**設置在**遠離主要道路的位置。

Practice 2

> The desk should be **situated** near the window.

書桌應該**放在窗邊**。

MCQ-ready definition:

situate X = 把 X 放置或安排在某個位置

22. **situate something in context** — 把某事放在背景 / 脈絡中理解

A major academic figurative extension.

Practice 1

> We need to **situate** the event in its historical context.

我們需要把事件**放在歷史脈絡中理解**。

Practice 2

> The report **situates** the problem within a broader social context.

報告把問題**放在更廣泛的社會背景中分析**。

MCQ-ready definition:

situate X in context = 把 X 放進較大的背景、時代或系統中理解

23. **situational** (情境性的 ; 與特定情況有關的) — 情境性的

Practice 1

> His reaction was **situational**, not typical of his personality.

他的反應是**由當時情境造成的**，並不是他一貫的性格。

Practice 2

> Stress can be highly **situational**.

壓力可能非常**視乎具體情況**。

MCQ-ready definition:

situational = 由某個特定情況造成或與其密切有關的

24. **situational factors — 情境因素**

Practice 1

> Several **situational factors** affected his judgment.

多個**情境因素**影響了他的判斷。

Practice 2

> We should consider both personal and **situational factors**.

我們應同時考慮個人和**情境因素**。

MCQ-ready definition:

situational factors = 某個特定環境或時刻中影響行為和結果的外在條件

25. **situational awareness — 情境意識；環境察覺能力**

A common technical/professional compound.

Practice 1

> Pilots need strong **situational awareness**.

機師需要很強的**情境意識**。

Practice 2

> Good **situational awareness** helps people respond quickly to danger.

良好的**環境察覺能力**有助人們快速應對危險。

MCQ-ready definition:

****situational awareness = 對周圍環境、正在發生的事及可能變化保持清楚掌握的能力****

Important distinction 1: ****situation vs condition****

****situation****

whole set of circumstances.

****condition****

a particular state or requirement.

> difficult situation

困難局面

> working conditions

工作條件

A situation may contain many conditions.

Important distinction 2: ****situation vs circumstance****

****situation****

the overall picture.

****circumstance****

one of the conditions affecting the situation.

> The situation was difficult because of several circumstances.

局面困難，是因為幾個客觀條件。

Plural ****circumstances**** can also mean overall life conditions, so there is overlap.

Important distinction 3: ****situation vs problem****

situation

neutral: can be good, bad, or ordinary.

problem

specifically something wrong or difficult.

> current situation

目前情況

does not necessarily mean there is a problem.

Important distinction 4: **situation vs issue**

situation

overall circumstances.

issue

specific topic/problem.

In the passage:

> situation = 整個尷尬、信任受損的局面

> issue = 可能只指那次誤會本身

Important distinction 5: **situation vs position**

situation

circumstances someone is in.

position

can mean circumstance too, but also status, location, stance, job.

> I'm in a difficult situation.

我處境困難。

> I'm in a difficult position.

also possible, often emphasizes what choices are available to me.

Important distinction 6: **situation vs context**

situation

what is happening.

context

background that helps explain or interpret it.

Kevin's accusation is part of the situation; deadline pressure is part of the context.

Important distinction 7: **handle vs mend a situation**

handle a situation

manage it.

mend a situation

repair it after damage.

In your passage, **mend** is stronger because the situation had already been damaged.

Important distinction 8: **improve vs resolve a situation**

improve

make better.

resolve

solve the underlying problem.

A situation can improve without being fully resolved.

Important distinction 9: **situation as location is formal**

> beautiful situation by the sea

is possible, but modern learners would usually use:

> beautiful location

So this branch is useful for recognition but not a priority for active everyday use.

Important distinction 10: **situated vs located**

situated

slightly more formal/descriptive.

located

very neutral.

> The hotel is situated near the beach.

> The hotel is located near the beach.

Both are natural.

Important distinction 11: **situate in context**

This does not mean physically put something somewhere.

It means:

place an idea/event inside its broader historical, social, or intellectual background

A very useful academic extension.

Important distinction 12: **situational vs temporary**

situational

caused by the particular circumstances.

temporary

does not last long.

A reaction can be situational and long-lasting, or temporary but not situational.

Family-extension note

Situation has a broad but coherent semantic core:

the set of conditions, events, and relationships surrounding a person or event at a particular time

It branches into:

1. **general circumstances**

- * current situation
- * difficult situation

2. **personal predicament**

- * be in a difficult situation

3. **domain-specific state**

- * financial situation
- * work situation

4. **management/change**

- * handle the situation
- * improve the situation
- * mend the situation

5. **formal location**

- * beautiful situation

6. **location family**

* situated
* situate

7. **contextual analysis**

* situate in context

8. **situational factors/awareness**

* situational
* situational awareness

For your passage, the exact branch is:

situation = the damaged interpersonal circumstances caused by the misunderstanding

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
situation	情況；局面	overall circumstances
in this situation	在這種情況下	current circumstances
difficult situation	困難處境	hard circumstances
awkward situation	尷尬局面	social discomfort
serious situation	嚴重情況	major consequences
current situation	目前情況	present state
financial situation	財務狀況	financial circumstances
family situation	家庭狀況	family circumstances
work situation	工作處境	employment circumstances
handle a situation	處理局面	manage
deal with a situation	應付情況	respond
improve the situation	改善情況	make better
mend the situation	修補局面	repair damage
make situation worse	令情況惡化	worsen
understand the situation	了解情況	grasp circumstances
situation changes	情況改變	circumstances shift
situation (formal location)	位置；地勢	physical setting
situated	位於；坐落於	location
well-situated	位置良好的	advantageous location
situate X	把 X 放置於	position
situate in context	放在脈絡中理解	contextualize
situational	情境性的	context-dependent
situational factors	情境因素	contextual influences

| **situational awareness** | 情境意識 | awareness of surroundings |

For your original sentence

> Of course, an apology does not erase everything overnight, but when it is honest, timely, and specific, it can really **mend the situation**.

Here:

situation = 那場誤會之後形成的整體人際局面：尷尬、不快、信任受損，以及組員之間的緊張**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 當然，道歉並不能一夜之間抹走所有事情，但只要它是真誠、及時而且具體的，就真的可以**修補局面**。

The useful distinction is:

> **problem** = 具體問題

> **situation** = 圍繞問題形成的整體局面

> **context** = 幫助理解局面的背景

In this passage, **situation** is the best fit because the apology is repairing not just one factual error, but the **whole damaged interpersonal atmosphere around it**.